

Codes around us

When we think of coding, we think of computers, but codes are all around us. Throughout history, humans have created many different codes for communicating. Some codes are used to send secret messages, while others deliver information across long distances. People who cannot see or hear can use codes to speak to each other.

Blind people use their hands to read Braille.

Morse code

Morse code sent messages long distance along electric wires. Each letter was represented by a series of dots and dashes tapped out on a special machine.



Morse code tapping machine

A ·—	M — —	Y — ···
B —···	N — ·	Z —···
C —···	O — — —	1 —···
D — ·	P —···	2 —···
E ·	Q —···	3 —···
F ···	R ···	4 —···
G —··	S ···	5 —···
H —··	T —	6 —···
I ··	U —··	7 —···
J —···	V —···	8 —···
K —··	W —··	9 —···
L —··	X —··	0 —···

This is a short sound, or a dot.

This is a long sound, or a dash.

! WOW!
The Ancient Egyptians had more than 700 different hieroglyphs.

Picture language

Ancient Egyptians didn't have an alphabet system. Instead, they used a series of pictures called hieroglyphs to represent sounds and words.

This stone is covered with hieroglyphs.

